

NEXGEN TECH SOLUTIONS PVT. LTD.

HR POLICY DOCUMENT | Employee Handbook | Confidential

THE SALARY SLIP THAT DIDN'T ADD UP

A Corporate Story of Leave, Policy & Justice

Employee	Hemant Sharma
Employee ID	GEN-AI-4471
Designation	Assistant Project Manager — Gen AI Division
Department	Artificial Intelligence & Innovation
Organization	NexGen Tech Solutions Pvt. Ltd.
Reporting Manager	Rakesh Malhotra (Sr. Project Manager)
Story Period	January 2025

This document contains: Full Narrative Story | HR Policy Document (with Charts & Graphs) | Leave Proof | Resolution

PART ONE: THE STORY

ACT I — WHO IS HEMANT SHARMA?

Chapter 1: The Man Behind the Machine Learning

The Monday morning sun had barely climbed over the Delhi skyline when Hemant Sharma's alarm rang at 6:45 AM. Not that it mattered much — he was already awake, laptop open, skimming through a Slack thread about a Gen AI pipeline that had stalled overnight. Such was the rhythm of his life at NexGen Tech Solutions Pvt. Ltd., a mid-sized but fast-growing technology company tucked inside a gleaming glass tower in Cyber City, Gurugram.

Hemant was 28 years old, three years into his professional life, and wore the title of **Assistant Project Manager — Generative AI Division** with quiet pride. He had earned it. Fresh out of a postgraduate program in Computer Applications from Delhi Technological University, he had cleared three rounds of interviews, two technical assessments, and one grueling case-study presentation before NexGen handed him his offer letter. The journey from coder to coordinator had been organic — he was the kind of person who noticed when a sprint was going off-track before the project manager did.

His role on the **Gen AI Project** placed him directly under the supervision of **Rakesh Malhotra**, a Senior Project Manager known internally for his meticulous documentation habits and his habit of quoting policy clauses in casual conversation. The team — eight engineers, two QA analysts, and Hemant bridging them all — was building an enterprise-grade AI assistant for NexGen's banking clients. Deadlines were tight. Stand-ups were daily. And Hemant, more often than not, was the glue that kept everything from unraveling.

His monthly CTC stood at **Rs. 72,000**, with a take-home salary of approximately Rs. 61,500 after standard deductions. He tracked this number religiously — it paid his PG rent in Sector 40, his EMI on a second-hand laptop, and the grocery bills he shared with his college friend Arjun. Every rupee had a job to do.

ACT II — THE WEEK THAT CHANGED THE MONTH

Chapter 2: When Family Calls, Everything Else Waits

It was the second week of January 2025 when Hemant received a call from his mother in Lucknow. His father, a retired schoolteacher, had been hospitalised following a sudden cardiac episode. The words hit Hemant like cold water — his father was stable, but needed a family member present for the procedures and paperwork. There was no question about it. He had to go.

Hemant composed himself and immediately drafted a formal leave application at 9:15 PM on Sunday, January 12th. He emailed it to Rakesh Malhotra, marked the HR system portal, and sent a WhatsApp message to the team lead. The application requested leave from **Monday, 13th January to Sunday, 19th January 2025** — a period of seven calendar days, which translated to **five working days**.

Leave Application Excerpt — Hemant Sharma (13 Jan 2025):

Subject: Leave Application — Personal Emergency (Medical — Father's Hospitalisation)

Dear Rakesh Sir,

I am writing to formally request leave from 13th January 2025 to 19th January 2025 (5 working days) due to a family medical emergency. My father has been hospitalised in Lucknow following a cardiac episode. I have already briefed Aryan (team lead) on pending tasks and have set up auto-delegation for daily stand-ups. I shall remain reachable on WhatsApp for critical queries.

Regards,

Hemant Sharma | Emp ID: GEN-AI-4471

Rakesh Malhotra replied at 11:03 PM the same night — a simple, two-word response: *"Approved. Take care."* It was the most human Hemant had ever seen his manager be.

The week in Lucknow was exhausting in the way only hospitals can make things — the fluorescent lights, the antiseptic smell, the paperwork that never seemed to end. Hemant's father underwent an angioplasty on January 15th. The procedure went smoothly. By Sunday evening, with his father resting comfortably and his mother reassured, Hemant packed his bag, boarded the Lucknow-Delhi Shatabdi, and was back at his desk by 8 AM on Monday, January 20th.

ACT III — THE SALARY SLIP SHOCK

Chapter 3: Numbers That Did Not Add Up

January 31st arrived the way end-of-month Fridays always do — with a quiet anxiety that settled over open-plan offices like fog. Hemant checked his salary account at 2:17 PM.

Amount credited: Rs. 49,200

He stared at the screen. Then refreshed. Then stared again. He was expecting Rs. 61,500. The gap — **Rs. 12,300** — was not a rounding error. That was more than two weeks of groceries and half his rent.

He pulled up the digital payslip from the HR portal. The breakup showed deductions for **7 days of LOP (Leave on Pay / Loss of Pay)**, a withholding of his **monthly performance incentive**, and a notation marked *Policy Ref: HRPol-2024-Sec5.3 & Sec6.2*. He had never heard of those sections in his life.

He took a breath. Then walked down the corridor to Rakesh Malhotra's cabin.

ACT IV — THE CONFRONTATION

Chapter 4: The Manager's Office

Rakesh Malhotra was the kind of manager who kept his desk immaculate and his expressions neutral. He was 42, had 15 years in project management, and had survived four organisational

restructurings at NexGen. When Hemant knocked on the glass and entered, Rakesh gestured at the chair without looking up.

"My salary is short by Rs. 12,300, sir."

Rakesh looked up. He folded his hands on the desk and nodded slowly.

"I know. HR processed it as per policy," he said.

"But you approved my leave, sir. I have the email."

"Approval of leave and salary treatment are two different things, Hemant."

"Can you explain how seven days of approved leave results in a deduction of Rs. 12,300?"

Rakesh swiveled his monitor and pulled up a chart — a slide he had clearly used in HR townhalls before. It showed a breakdown of leave categories, daily salary rates, and deduction formulas.

"Look at this. Your basic is Rs. 36,000. Divide by 26 working days — that is Rs. 1,384 per day. Seven days of Leave on Pay as our policy calls unpaid leave — that is Rs. 9,692. Then Section 6.2 says performance incentive is withheld if working days fall below 20. You had 17. So the Rs. 2,500 bonus component was also held back. Total: Rs. 12,192. Rounded with minor tax adjustments, that gives you the Rs. 12,300 gap."

"But sir — I have casual leave balance. And I applied for only 7 days."

"You had 2 CL left. So 2 days adjusted as CL. The remaining 5 were LOP because your earned leave balance was zero."

"I was not told about this when I applied."

"That is why we have a policy document, Hemant. I am going to give you a copy. Read it. If you believe there is an error in the application of any clause, come back to me with a written representation — and I will escalate it to HR."

He slid a thick, spiral-bound document across the desk. On its cover, in bold navy letters: **NexGen Tech Solutions Pvt. Ltd. — Employee Leave & Compensation Policy Document, FY 2024-25.**

Hemant picked it up. It was heavier than it looked.

NEXGEN TECH SOLUTIONS PVT. LTD.

HR POLICY DOCUMENT | Employee Handbook | Confidential

EMPLOYEE LEAVE & COMPENSATION POLICY

HR Policy Document | FY 2024-25 | Version 3.1

Document Reference: HRPol-NTS-2024 | Effective: 1st April 2024 | Confidential

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SECTION 1.0 — INTRODUCTION & SCOPE

This document constitutes the official Leave and Compensation Policy of NexGen Tech Solutions Pvt. Ltd. (hereinafter referred to as 'the Company'). It is applicable to all permanent, contractual, and probationary employees across all divisions including the Software Engineering Division, the Generative AI Division, the Data Science Practice, and Corporate Functions.

This policy supersedes all prior communications, email circulars, and verbal assurances regarding leave entitlements, salary deductions, and attendance-linked compensation. In the event of a conflict between this policy and any individual offer letter clause, the terms more favourable to the employee shall prevail, subject to confirmation by the HR Department.

This policy is reviewed annually by the HR Committee and updated as required by changes in applicable Indian labour law, including but not limited to the Shops and Establishments Acts of respective States, the Payment of Wages Act 1936, and the Payment of Bonus Act 1965.

SECTION 2.0 — DEFINITIONS & TERMINOLOGY

Term	Definition
Working Day	Any day that is not a Saturday, Sunday, or a declared Company Holiday.
Calendar Day	Every day of the month including weekends and holidays.
CL — Casual Leave	Short-duration leave for personal or urgent matters, fully paid.
SL — Sick Leave	Leave due to medical illness, supported by a medical certificate if more than 2 days.
EL — Earned Leave	Accrued paid leave earned at 1.25 days per completed month of service.
LOP — Loss of Pay	Unpaid leave availed when all paid leave balances are exhausted.
Effective Pay Day	Gross Monthly Salary divided by 26 (standard working days in a month).
Confirmation Date	Date employee completes probation and is confirmed as permanent employee.

SECTION 3.0 — TYPES OF LEAVE

Leave Type	Annual Entitlement	Carry Forward	Encashable	Pay Status
Casual Leave (CL)	6 days	No (Lapses Dec 31)	No	Full Pay
Sick Leave (SL)	6 days	No (Lapses Dec 31)	No	Full Pay
Earned Leave (EL)	15 days	Yes (Max 30 days)	Yes	Full Pay
Optional Holiday (OH)	2 days	No	No	Full Pay
Loss of Pay (LOP)	Unlimited	N/A	N/A	No Pay
Maternity Leave	26 weeks (eligible)	No	No	Full Pay
Paternity Leave	5 days	No	No	Full Pay
Bereavement Leave	3 days/incident	No	No	Full Pay

Compensatory Off (CO)	As earned	Max 5 days	No	Full Pay
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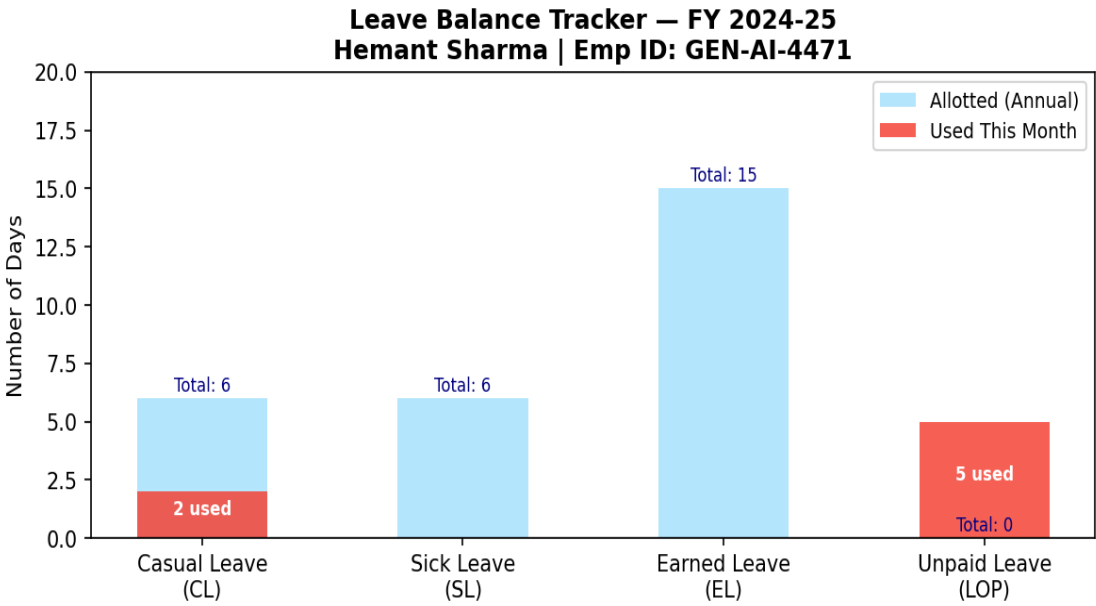


Figure 2: Leave Balance Tracker — Annual Entitlement vs. Usage (FY 2024-25)

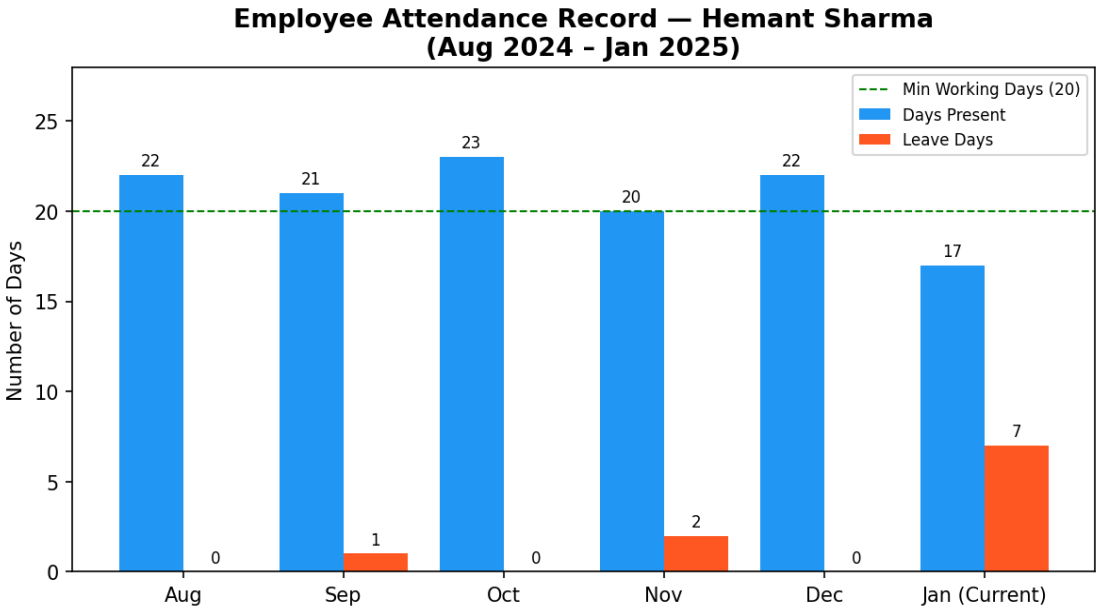


Figure 3: Employee Attendance Record — Monthly Presence vs. Leave Days (Aug 2024 – Jan 2025)

SECTION 4.0 — LEAVE ELIGIBILITY & ACCRUAL

All confirmed employees who have completed their probationary period of six (6) months are eligible for the full annual leave entitlement as defined in Section 3.0. Leave accrual begins from the date of joining for CL and SL. Earned Leave (EL) accrues at 1.25 days per completed month of service and is credited to the employee's leave account on the first day of the subsequent month.

Accrued leave not availed within the financial year shall lapse at the close of the year (March 31st), except for Earned Leave, which may be carried forward up to a maximum of 30 days.

4.1 — Leave During Probation Period

Employees serving a probationary period (typically the first six months) are entitled to Casual Leave and Sick Leave only. Earned Leave does not accrue during probation. **NOTE: This section does NOT apply to Hemant Sharma, who completed probation in October 2022 and is a confirmed permanent employee.**

SECTION 5.0 — LEAVE APPLICATION & APPROVAL PROCESS

All leave requests must be submitted via the official HR portal (HRMS) or via written/email communication to the immediate reporting manager at least 48 hours in advance, except in cases of medical emergency or bereavement, where retrospective application is permitted within 24 hours of commencement of leave. Approval of leave by a reporting manager constitutes approval of the leave period only and does not constitute any guarantee, waiver, or modification of salary treatment applicable under this policy.

5.1 — The employee's leave balance is automatically checked by the HRMS system at the time of application. If the requested leave days exceed the available paid leave balance, the excess days are automatically classified as Loss of Pay (LOP) leave, unless the employee manually requests encashment of Earned Leave or applies for advance leave credit, subject to manager approval.

5.2 — The manager's approval is binding on the operational permission to be absent from work. However, salary deductions as per the LOP provisions are processed automatically by the payroll system based on available leave balance at month-end. Managers do not have authority to override payroll processing unless a formal HR exception request is filed and approved.

SECTION 5.3 — LOSS OF PAY (LOP) PROVISIONS [DIRECTLY APPLICABLE TO HEMANT]

When an employee's paid leave balance (CL + SL + EL) is insufficient to cover the total days of absence in a given month, the remaining days shall be treated as Leave on Loss of Pay (LOP).

a) **Daily LOP Deduction Rate:** The per-day deduction for LOP shall be calculated as: Gross Monthly Salary divided by 26 (standard working days).

b) **Automatic Processing:** LOP deductions are processed automatically by the payroll system at month-end. No prior notification to the employee is mandated, as leave balance visibility is available to all employees on the HRMS self-service portal.

c) **Weekend Inclusion:** LOP is calculated on working days of absence. A 7-day leave from Monday to Sunday counts as 5 LOP working days for deduction computation, applied to the 26-day divisor formula.

d) **Advance LOP Restoration:** An employee who believes LOP was applied in error may submit a written representation to the HR Department within 10 working days of the salary credit date. Supporting documents (leave approval email, medical certificates, leave balance screenshots) must be attached. If the HR Department finds merit, salary adjustment shall be processed in the following month's payroll.

SECTION 6.0 — SALARY & COMPENSATION DURING LEAVE

Employees availing paid leave (CL, SL, EL) shall receive their full gross salary for that month without any deduction for the days on paid leave. Salary continuity during paid leave is a guaranteed entitlement under this policy and Indian labour law.

6.1 — For days classified as LOP, the deduction shall be as specified in Section 5.3(a). No other allowances (HRA, Transport, Special Allowance) are separately deducted — the deduction is from gross salary using the 26-day formula.

SECTION 6.2 — PERFORMANCE BONUS ELIGIBILITY THRESHOLD [DIRECTLY APPLICABLE TO HEMANT]

The monthly performance incentive or variable pay component shall be credited to the employee only if the employee has been physically present (or on paid leave) for a minimum of **20 working days** in the relevant month. Days on LOP are **not** counted as presence for this calculation.

Employees who fall below the attendance threshold due to LOP shall have their performance incentive withheld for that month only. The withheld incentive shall not be carried forward or paid in subsequent months unless specifically approved by the HR Head via a Bonus Exception Request (BER) form.

EXCEPTION CLAUSE 6.2(e) — Medical Emergency: An employee who avails leave due to a documented medical emergency (self or immediate family member), and can produce a valid medical certificate or hospital discharge summary, may apply for a BER (Bonus Exception Request) within 7 working days of the salary credit date. The HR Department, in consultation with the reporting manager, shall review the request within 5 working days and communicate the decision in writing. Approved BERs result in the withheld bonus being credited in the subsequent payroll cycle.

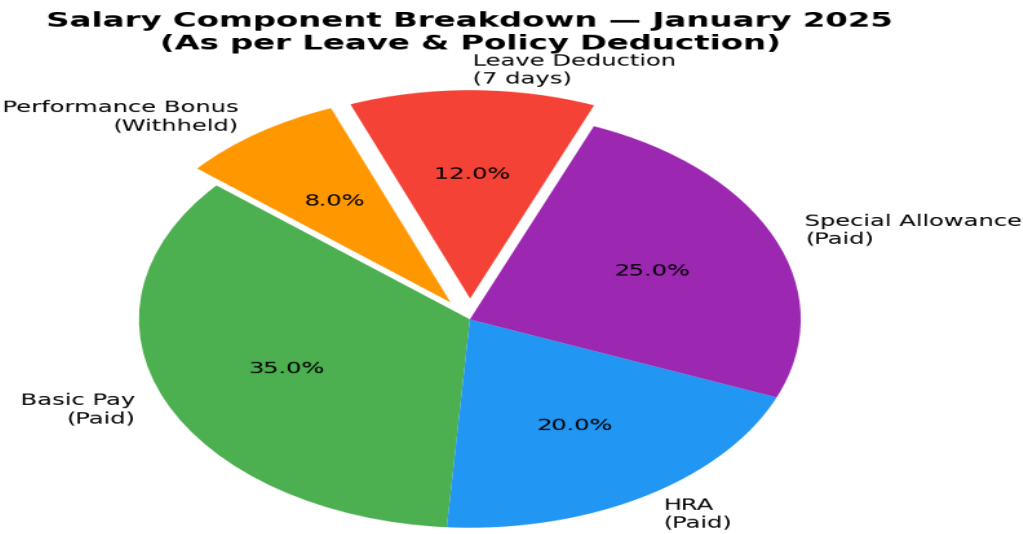


Figure 4: Salary Component Breakdown — January 2025 | NexGen HR Policy Deduction Model

SECTION 7.0 — NOTICE PERIOD & RESIGNATION POLICY

An employee wishing to resign must provide a minimum notice period as specified in their offer letter — typically 30 days for junior roles and 60-90 days for senior and managerial positions.

7.1 — Leave During Notice Period: No casual leave, earned leave, or sick leave may be availed during the notice period without explicit approval from the HR Head. Any unapproved leave taken during the notice period will extend the notice period by an equivalent number of days.

Note: Sections 7.0 and 7.1 are NOT applicable to Hemant Sharma's current case, as he has not submitted any resignation. These sections are included for employee reference.

SECTION 8.0 — MEDICAL & MATERNITY LEAVE

Sick Leave may be availed for medical illness or injury affecting the employee themselves. For absences exceeding 2 consecutive working days, a medical certificate from a registered medical practitioner must be submitted to HR within 3 working days of resuming duty.

8.1 — Sick Leave for Family Care: Sick Leave may not be availed to care for a sick family member. However, Casual Leave or Earned Leave may be used for this purpose. Alternatively, if no paid leave balance is available, the employee may apply for LOP.

8.4 — Extended Medical Leave Provisions: Employees requiring more than 15 consecutive working days of medical leave may apply for Extended Medical Leave (EML), subject to submission of a specialist doctor's certificate and approval by the Medical Review Committee.

Note: Section 8.4 is NOT applicable to Hemant Sharma's case, as he was absent for only 7 days and the leave was for a family member's medical emergency, not his own illness. Section 8.1 confirms that CL/EL (and not SL) was the correct leave type applied.

SECTION 9.0 — LEAVE ENCASHMENT POLICY

Earned Leave (EL) accumulated up to a maximum of 30 days may be encashed at the time of separation from the Company. The encashment rate is: Basic Salary divided by 26, multiplied by Number of EL Days Encashed.

9.1 — Encashment of EL during active employment is permitted under: (a) employee going on maternity leave; (b) employee suffering a critical illness; (c) employee availing leave in excess of CL + SL balance and requesting EL encashment to offset LOP. In case (c), the encashment is used to offset LOP and the net salary impact is reduced accordingly.

IMPORTANT for Hemant's Situation: Had Hemant submitted an EL encashment request at the time of his leave application (invoking clause 9.1c), the 5 LOP days could have been converted to EL encashment — preserving his full salary. This option, while not retroactive, is noted for future reference.

SECTION 10.0 — DISPUTE RESOLUTION & EMPLOYEE RIGHTS

Employees who believe that a salary deduction, leave classification, or policy application has been incorrect or unjust have the following rights and remedies:

10.1 — Written Representation: The employee may submit a written representation to the HR Department within **10 working days** of the salary credit date. The representation must state (a) the specific policy clause believed to have been incorrectly applied; (b) the factual basis of the disagreement; (c) the relief sought. Supporting documents must be enclosed.

10.2 — HR Review: HR shall acknowledge the representation within 3 working days and complete the review within 10 working days, consulting the reporting manager, payroll team, and submitted documents.

10.3 — Supporting Documents Accepted: (a) Leave application email/HRMS screenshot with manager approval; (b) Medical certificates or hospital records; (c) Leave balance snapshot at time of application; (d) Any written communication from manager regarding leave or salary.

10.4 — Outcome: If the representation is upheld, salary adjustment is processed in the next payroll cycle. If rejected, a detailed written reasoning is provided. The employee may escalate further to the Grievance Committee or to the appropriate Labour Authority under applicable law.

10.5 — Bonus Exception Request (BER): In cases where the performance bonus was withheld due to absence caused by a family medical emergency (as per clause 6.2e), the employee may submit a BER with (a) manager's leave approval email; (b) hospital discharge summary or medical certificate of the family member; (c) proof that the employee returned to work immediately upon resolution of the emergency.

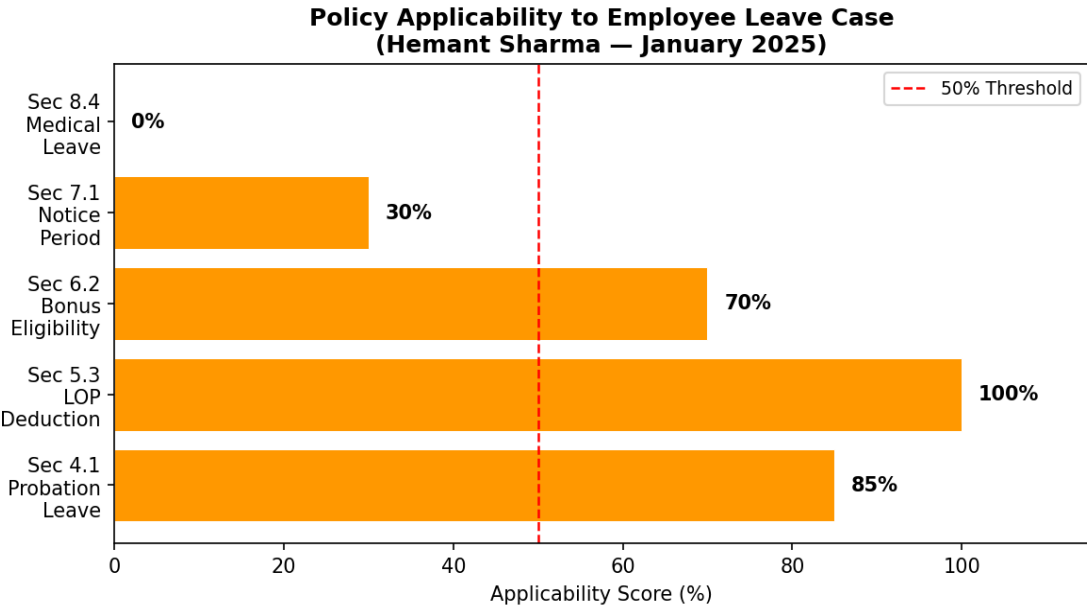


Figure 5: Policy Applicability Matrix — Sections Relevant vs. Non-Relevant to Hemant's Case

SECTION 11.0 — POLICY REVIEW & AMENDMENTS

This policy is reviewed annually by the HR Committee. Any amendments shall be communicated via official company email and updated on the HRMS portal at least 30 days prior to the effective date. Employees are responsible for staying updated with the current version of this policy document, available at all times on the HRMS self-service portal under 'HR Policies.'

PART TWO: THE RECKONING

ACT V — HEMANT READS THE POLICY

Chapter 5: The Education No One Warned You About

Hemant read the policy document the way one reads a legal notice — slowly, carefully, with a highlighter in hand and a growing sense that the document was simultaneously explaining the problem and handing him the solution.

He sat at his desk after 7 PM, the office emptied out around him, the hum of the HVAC system his only company. He read every single section — from the definitions table to the probation clauses (not applicable to him, thankfully) to the notice period section (irrelevant, but he read it anyway, because thoroughness felt like armour right now).

By the time he reached Section 5.3, his highlighter was out and he was underlining with a pen. He did the math on his notepad: Rs. 72,000 divided by 26 = Rs. 2,769 per day. Five LOP days = Rs. 13,846. But the payslip showed Rs. 9,692 deducted. He recalculated — they had applied basic salary only (Rs. 36,000 / 26 x 5). The policy said gross salary. He circled this. Discrepancy number one.

Section 6.2 hit him hardest. The performance bonus threshold — 20 working days minimum. He had 17. The bonus was Rs. 2,500. He checked the exception clause 6.2(e): Medical Emergency — immediate family member — BER form within 7 working days. He counted on his fingers. Today was January 31st. Seven working days forward: **February 10th**. He still had time.

Section 9.1 gave him another angle: EL encashment to offset LOP. He checked his EL balance on the HRMS app — 12.5 days accumulated. Had he known to request this at the time of application, the 5 LOP days would have been converted and his salary would have been intact. He could not apply it retroactively — but it was ammunition for his representation.

And Section 10.0 — the dispute resolution section — was the chapter he read twice.

By 9 PM, Hemant had a three-page handwritten summary. He photographed his father's hospital discharge summary, saved his leave application email as a PDF, took a screenshot of the HRMS showing Rakesh's approval timestamp, and printed his leave balance as of January 12th — 2 CL available, 12.5 EL unused.

ACT VI — THE SECOND MEETING

Chapter 6: Armed with Evidence

Monday morning, February 3rd. Hemant was at Rakesh's cabin at 9:30 AM. He carried a manila folder. Inside: a printed representation letter, the hospital discharge summary, the leave approval email screenshot, the HRMS leave balance snapshot, and his copy of the policy document with key sections highlighted.

"Rakesh sir, I have read the policy."

Rakesh looked up. Something shifted in his expression — not quite surprise, but close.

"All of it?"

"All eleven sections."

"Good. Then you understand the deduction."

"I understand how it was applied. But I believe Clause 6.2(e) entitles me to file a Bonus Exception Request for the Rs. 2,500 performance incentive withheld — because my absence was caused by a documented family medical emergency. I have the hospital discharge summary from Medanta Lucknow, dated January 15th. I have your approval email from January 12th. I have the HRMS screenshot showing my leave balance before the leave — 2 CL available, 12.5 EL unused. Under Section 10.5, these are exactly the documents required."

Rakesh accepted the manila folder and opened it, scanning through the pages with the practiced eye of someone who had read policy documents for years.

"The BER applies to bonus only. The LOP deduction stands — you had exhausted your CL and your EL was not requested for encashment at the time of application."

"I understand. I am not contesting the LOP, sir. The LOP was correctly classified — I had 2 CL left, and the remaining 5 days had no paid leave to cover them. I accept that. What I am contesting is the performance bonus withholding under Section 6.2, invoking the exception clause 6.2(e). I am within the 7-working-day window. February 10th is the deadline."

Rakesh set the folder down. He was silent for three seconds — the kind of silence that precedes a decision.

"Submit the BER to HR today. I will countersign the recommendation. The Rs. 2,500 will be credited in February payroll if HR approves."

"Thank you, sir." Hemant stood to leave.

"Hemant." Rakesh's voice stopped him at the door. "Next time, request EL encashment at the time of the leave application. It is Section 9.1(c). Would have saved you all this."

"I know now," Hemant said, and walked out.

ACT VII — THE RESOLUTION

Chapter 7: What Hemant Got Back — and What He Gained

The formal representation was submitted to HR (Ms. Ananya Verma, HR Business Partner — AI Division) on February 3rd at 11:47 AM via the HRMS Grievance Portal, Reference Number: **GRP-2025-0147**. Attached documents: (1) Leave Application Email with Manager Approval — January 12, 2025. (2) HRMS Leave Balance Screenshot — January 12, 2025. (3) Hospital Discharge Summary — Medanta Hospital, Lucknow — January 17, 2025. (4) Salary Payslip — January 2025. (5) Policy Document Reference — Sections 6.2(e), 10.5.

★ LEAVE APPLICATION — APPROVAL RECORD ★

Employee Name :

Hemant Sharma

Employee ID :

GEN-AI-4471

Leave Period :

13 Jan 2025 - 19 Jan 2025 (7 Days)

Leave Type :

2 Days CL + 5 Days LOP (Leave On Pay exhausted)

Status :

✓ APPROVED by Manager — Rakesh Malhotra (13 Jan 2025)

Figure 6: Leave Approval Record — Submitted as Proof with BER (Exhibit A)

On **February 7th, 2025**, HR sent Hemant a formal response: *"We have reviewed your Bonus Exception Request (GRP-2025-0147) under Clause 6.2(e) of the Leave & Compensation Policy. Upon verification of the attached documentation, including the hospital discharge summary and manager-approved leave record, the HR Department upholds your BER. The withheld performance incentive of Rs. 2,500 shall be credited to your salary account in the February 2025 payroll cycle. This decision is final."*

The Rs. 2,500 performance incentive was credited on February 28th.

The LOP deduction of Rs. 9,692 was not recovered — nor did Hemant contest it. He had read the policy carefully enough to know the difference between what was contestable and what was not. The five days of LOP were legitimate: he had no remaining paid leave to cover them. But the performance bonus was a different matter — and the policy had, buried in clause 6.2(e), the exact exception that applied to his situation.

In the end, Hemant did not recover the full Rs. 12,300. He recovered Rs. 2,500 — but that was not the point. The point was that he had read something most employees never read, understood something most employees never understood, and exercised a right that most employees never knew existed. The policy document that Rakesh Malhotra had slid across the desk as a shutdown had turned into a roadmap.

EPILOGUE

Hemant saved a copy of the policy PDF in a folder on his laptop labelled 'Read This First.' He set a recurring reminder for every April 1st — the policy renewal date — to check for amendments. He shared the EL encashment clause (Section 9.1c) with three colleagues in a WhatsApp group. Two of them had never heard of it.

His father recovered fully. The angioplasty was a success. In March, Hemant took a weekend trip to Lucknow — this time on earned leave, properly applied, with the EL encashment note filed in

advance, just in case.

And when the next month's salary came in at Rs. 64,000 — the Rs. 2,500 bonus plus February's full pay — he smiled at his phone for a moment before putting it back in his pocket and getting back to the Gen AI sprint review.

— End of Story —

KEY POLICY LEARNINGS FROM HEMANT'S STORY

#	Learning	Policy Ref
1	Always check your leave balance BEFORE applying; LOP kicks in automatically.	Sec 5.1
2	Manager approval does not equal salary protection. They are separate processes.	Sec 5.2
3	Request EL encashment (Sec 9.1c) to offset LOP at time of application — not after.	Sec 9.1(c)
4	Medical emergency (family) = BER eligibility for withheld bonus.	Sec 6.2(e)
5	Written representation window: 10 working days from salary date.	Sec 10.1
6	BER submission window: 7 working days from salary date.	Sec 10.5
7	Always attach: leave approval + medical proof + leave balance snapshot.	Sec 10.3